

ably put \$10,000 of your funds in government securities, a solid foundation if all hell breaks loose. Don't get me wrong. If you say 'hell with safety,' we'll do something else. I'd also buy you some common stocks, growth mutual funds, real estate limited partnerships DEFINITELY. That's the best of both worlds."

I asked what he meant by both worlds. "Income and appreciation," he said. "Look at your house. If I said I'd buy it, would you sell it to me now for what it was worth four years ago?" I told him I would be happy to do that right away, since real estate values had gone down in my neighborhood. Mr. Nemerov was momentarily flustered but quickly recovered. "Just my point," he retorted. "With a real estate partnership you get income and so forth while the investment has more time to appreciate. A growth-oriented person like you would appreciate the appreciation."

During most of our talk, Mr. Nemerov gave me about a third of his attention. Another third was absorbed by the phone, and the final third directed at the computer screen suspended on a gooseneck halfway between two cubicles. Every few seconds, he'd spin the screen around to peer at a list of stock prices, and the adjacent broker would spin it back in the other direction.

After one of their tugs-of-war, the man in the next cubicle leaned over and introduced himself as Rick. Mr. Nemerov said Rick was very short-term and the two of them could go partners with me if I decided to work in that direction. "Two for the price of one," he said. I smiled, which must have made Mr. Nemerov think he was on the right track, because then he pronounced, "Out of your \$50,000, we should definitely hold back a few thousand so we're ready to jump in if Rick comes up with something."

Rick, who'd gone into a new frenzy of goosenecking, announced over the half-wall that he'd come up with something already. How would I like to buy some Texaco, then selling for \$30 a share, for \$27 a share instead? I said I doubted that was possible, and suspected some kind of trick. Rick said it wasn't a trick. All I had to do was buy the stock and sell some put options at the same time. I told Rick I'd already had experience with options, especially the IBM October put and the June call.

"Options!" gushed Mr. Nemerov. "I'd like to see you in some covered calls. That's not so risky. We can negotiate the commis-